



MINISO canada

Public Relations and Advertising Strategic Campaigns

Group 9

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Situation Analysis

MINISO

External Analysis

Economic

Retail industry in Canada is gradually becoming **polarized**
"Ultra-low-price" discount stores or high-end brands
Mid-range retailers are often "caught in the middle" and **struggling hard**

Social

Characteristics of young Canadian consumers in retail consumption:

- Prone to impulse spending due to advertisements on **social media**
- Increased sensitivity to price and value, focusing on **cost-effectiveness**
- Preference for daily necessities with **strong design and clear functions**

(Waterloo Business Review, 2018) (Barnabe, 2025)

Internal Analysis

MINISO is a **mid-range retailer** in Canada

- No sufficient low prices
- No strong brand influence to attract people who value quality

Its situation is rather awkward in the market

MINISO is more perceived as just a somewhat **trendy "cheap brand"**

(Dhopade, 2017)



Competitor Analysis

MINISO

Why they?

These brands in the Canadian market respectively represent ultra-low-cost mass retail (Dollarama), design lifestyle retail (IKEA), and Japanese lifestyle department store category overlap (Oomomo), and they have **direct or indirect competitive relationships with Miniso in terms of price, positioning or category.**



Brand Position

Mass
Discount Retail

High cost-
performance
Japanese Lifestyle
experience

Home design
that
Everyone can
afford

Price

1 – 4 CAD
Up to 5 CAD

1 to a few
hundred CAD

1 to a few
hundred CAD

Style

- Shelf displays are basic
- Emphasizing practicality and affordability
- Packaging is plain
- Little brand design appeal.

- Japanese Minimalism
- Cute Style
- Emphasizing Japan + Lifestyle

- Emphasis on functional design
- Modern and Fashionable Aesthetic
- Visual consistency



Threat to MINISO

- **Price threat:** As a long-established low-price retail giant, Dollarama has a strong supply chain and customer base. If it further lowers prices or expands product categories.
- **Lifestyle Substitution Threat:** IKEA's overlap with MINISO in categories such as kitchen, storage and decoration may divert MINISO's target customer base.
- **Conceptual Overlap Threat:** As a Japanese lifestyle department store brand, Oomomo is highly similar to MINISO in terms of product types, price ranges and consumption scenarios. Moreover, it has the advantage of first-mover offline layout in some cities, directly competing with the same young consumer group.



Data Analysis

Primary Research N= 105 Snowball Sampling

Which age group do you belong to?

15-19 (Student)	35%
20-26 (College students/new entrants)	50%
27-35	10%
Under 15 / Over 35	5%

Compared to other seasons, how would you describe your overall mood during Canada's long, cold winter ?

Significantly worse (more depressed, tired, or irritable)	45%	47
Slightly worse (less energetic, more moody than usual)	35%	37
About the same (no obvious difference)	15%	16
Better (more relaxed or joyful)	5%	5

Would you buy MINISO products specifically for "emotional needs" (e.g., curing bad mood, relieving stress, seeking comfort)?

Never (从不)	55%	58
Rarely (only if there's no other choice) (很少, 仅无其他选择时)	25%	26
Occasionally (偶尔)	15%	16
Often (经常)	5%	5

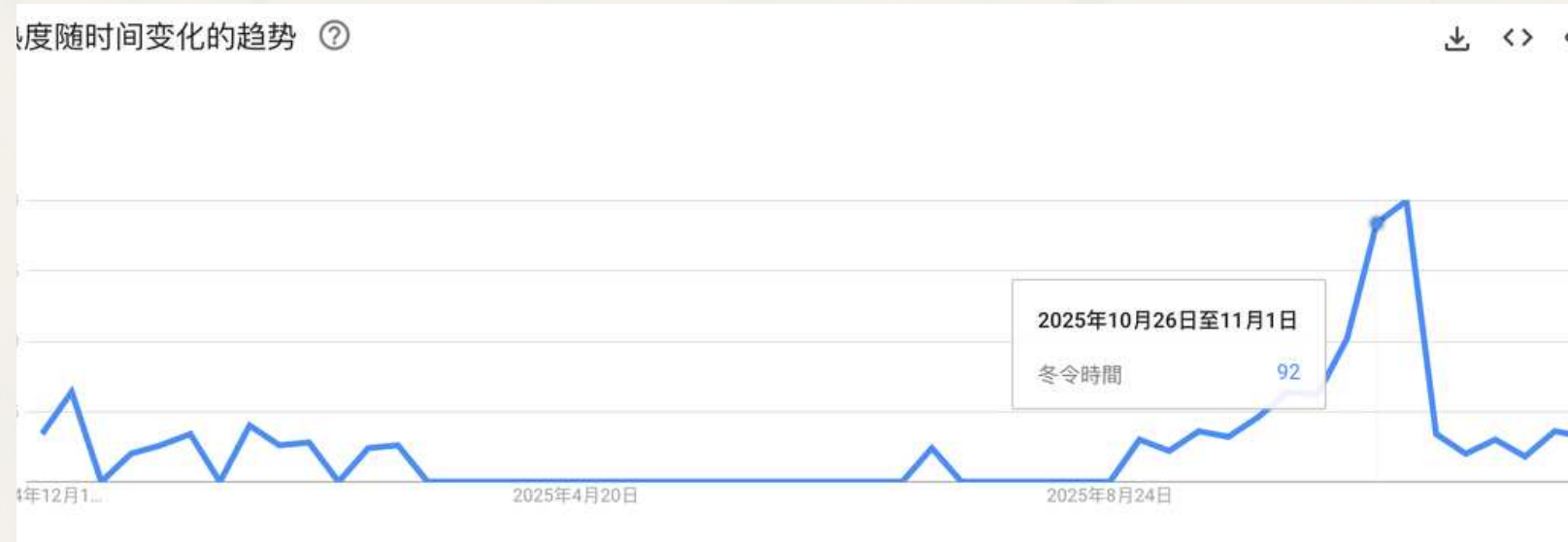
Have "little treats" (affordable, small joys in daily life) helped improve your mood during winter?

Yes, greatly improved (made me much happier/less stressed)	40%	42
Yes, somewhat improved (helped lift my mood a bit)	45%	47
Not really (no obvious effect)	10%	11
No, not at all	5%	5



Data Analysis

Secondary Research



Source: Google Trend

#Winter Time

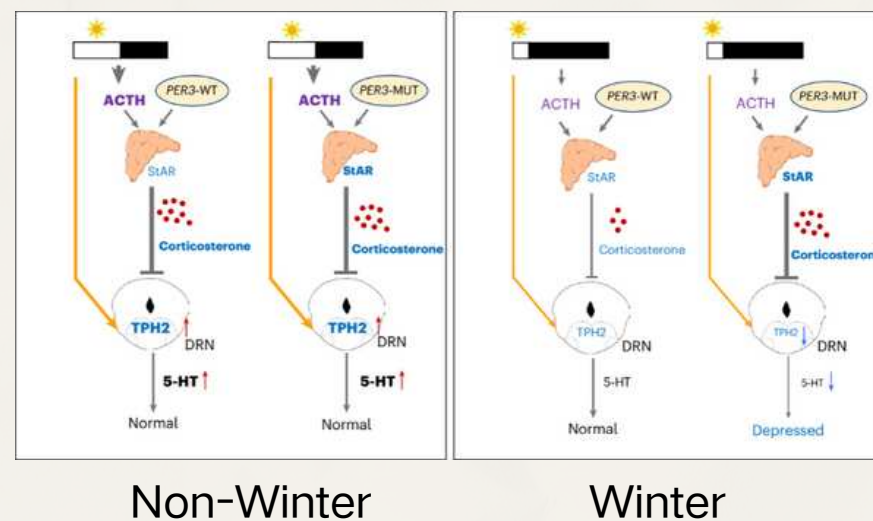
- The topic of winter time has a peak period on social media.



Source: Brand24.com

#Winter Blue

- The topic of the winter of social media
- The trend of negative emotions.



SAD
Age: 15-26



Seasonal Affective Disorder

People's moods can be affected by the season in winter, leading to depression.
(Zhang & Tang, 2024)

- Daily Events & Life Satisfaction
- Daily Events & Positive Emotions

R^2 to 40.2%
 R^2 to 43.2%



Daily Events enhance
Life satisfaction & Positive emotions



Target Audience

MINISO

Audience:

Occupation:

- Student (Middle school, university, and international students)
- New to the workforce

Age: 15-26

Income: Budget-conscious

Purchase Occasion:

- Preference for cute, playful items---Little threats
- Active users on social media
- Emotional value driven --- Affordable happiness

Lifestyle:

- Unstable housing (dorms, shared housing)
- Fast-paced and high-pressure
- Micro-joy seeking
- Seasonal affection disorder (SAD)

Region:

- Urban (Toronto, Montreal, Vancouver)

Why are these Cities?

Large population: 3 M

Toronto

Education hub:

- University students
- International students.

Ontario Miniso Store: 28/51

Winter Time: Fast paced Life. Freezing

Large population: 1.97 M

Montreal

Education hub

Ontario Miniso Store: 7/51

Winter time: Strong sense of experience

Large population: 2.7 M

Vancouver

Diversified: 50% not English native

Ontario Miniso Store: 8/51

Winter time: Rainy



Problem statement & Insight

Problem Statement

MINISO has no clear brand positioning in Canada

Consumers have not yet recognised its unique “Mood Booster” value proposition, and are not buying into the whole “IP culture” thing, making it difficult to differentiate from competitors.

Market Perspective: The market offers Cheap Utility or Expensive Joy.

- **Low burden, low aesthetics** (e.g., Dollarama): Shopping here serves purely survival needs and fails to deliver enjoyment.
- **High aesthetics, high burden** (e.g., IKEA/boutiques): The barriers to accessing these experiences (financial cost, time investment, and decision-making effort) are prohibitively high.

Insight 1 (Market): The Absence of Low-Cost Emotional Value.

Canada’s retail sector is polarized, lacking a middle ground that offers both **affordability** and **emotional gratification**.

Target Audiences Perspective: They are enduring a Double Winter.

- **The physical winter:** Long, cold, and sun-deprived seasons lead to widespread **SAD**
- **The lifestyle winter:** They're seeking low-cost ways to live. Unable to afford expensive luxuries or spontaneous trips.

Insight 2 (TA): They crave Little Treats as an Emotional Survival Mechanism.

Powerless against the long winter and uncertainties of life, they prioritize immediate, low-effort emotional fulfillment.



Big idea: **Spark the MINI moment**



What is **Spark**?

The Emotional Trigger:

In the long, grey winter, **spark** represents the highlights in ordinary day and the instant emotional uplift.

What does **"Mini"** stand for?

The Triple Meanings:

Identity (Who): MINISO itself. A signature of brand presence.

Benefit (How): Low Burden. Affordable treats that offer instant gratification without stress.

Context (When): Micro-Moments. Not grand celebrations, but the ordinary pauses in daily life that deserve to be sparked.

Key Message

MINISO goes beyond affordable products, transforming little treats into accessible emotional support, lighting up the gray winter days with every micro-moment.

Message House



Big Idea

Key Message

MINISO goes beyond affordable products, transforming little treats into accessible emotional support, lighting up the gray winter days with every micro-moment.

Target Audience

Canadian Gen Z (Aged 15-26). Those enduring a “Double Winter” (Physical SAD + Lifestyle financial pressure) who crave “Little Treats” as an emotional survival mechanism.

Narrative Strategy

The “Switch”
Visualizing the transformation from “Grey Winter” to “MINISO Glow” through high-contrast aesthetics.

The “Healer”
Shifting the community mood from Isolation to Collective Connection and healing.

Key Info.

Miniso Gives The Source of Spark

The Exchange of Spark with TA

TA are the true source of Miniso’s light

Operational strategy

Phase 1 (W1-W2): Ignite (Trigger)

Phase 2 (W2-W3): Blaze (Explosion)

Phase 3 (W4): Glow (Sustain)

Marketing Goal

Brand Positioning & Identity Awakening

Active Engagement & Social Buzz

Long-term affection & Emotional Bonding

Action

- “Spark the MINI Moment” Concept TVC Launch.
- City Skyline Lighting posters

- City Skyline Lighting Event
- Subway Out door display and event
- #UntillFoundMySpark Transition Challenge on IG/TikTok.
- In-store traffic conversion event.

- “The Endless Mini Spark” Community Recap Video.
- UGC Lottery Interaction: social proof (Winners' unboxing content).



Metro Sparks

Reasons

- High volume of people flow
- Having an excellent viewing position
- Routes frequently used by our TA

Site selection

Toronto:

Dupont Station
Rosedale Station
Union Station

Montreal:

Sherbrooke Station
Plamondon Station
Georges-Vanier Station

Vancouver:

22nd Street
Commercial-Broadway

Drive consumers to physical stores

11.2~11.15 Week2-Week3

What is the event1?

A visual reminder placed beside the subway exit escalator

Why is the event? (Spark)

The transition from **light to darkness** the moment commuters exit the subway station transforms into a **small, emotionally ignited moment**



(Toronto: Dupont Station)



Metro Sparks

What is the event?

A decorated metro space featuring a *Photo Booth*, where passers-by are unexpectedly photographed and gifted their photos

Timeline

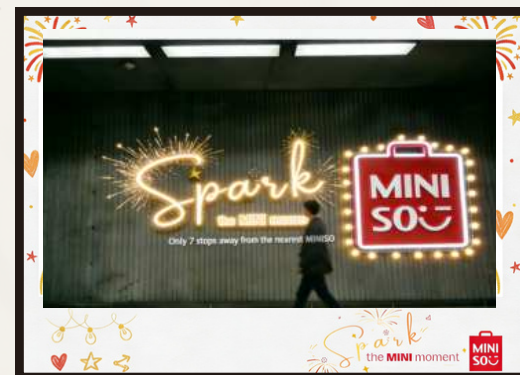
11.2



KOLs-led photo booth

11.3~11.8

MINISO staff-led photo booth



Participants will receive photo booth & a custom greeting card

Why is the event? (Spark)

Being captured and receiving a photo in an ordinary commuting space turns a routine moment into a small, delightful surprise



Spark the Dusk

Week 2
(11.2-11.8)

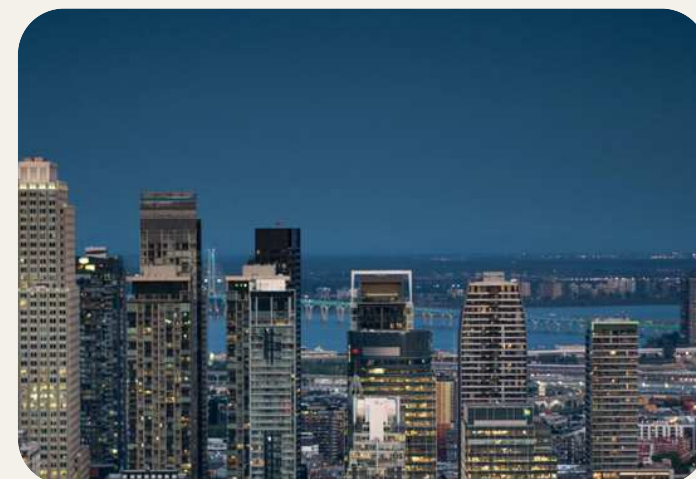
City Skyline



Toronto
Toronto island



Vancouver
Stanley Park



Montreal
Mount Royal

Why these cities & locations

High symbolic value
Scenic & visible at dusk
High foot traffic
Strong MINISO presence

Day 1 lighting activity KOLs (Example)



- 20 KOLs in each city activity, such as : kaur_moh & k_kimii_.....
- Taking into account the types of KOLs (models, lifestyle creators), as well as the locations of KOLs.

What is this event?

A week-long city lighting ritual where a traditional lamplighter sparks the moment when the city lights up.

Why a lamplighting ritual

Lamplighting is a traditional Western ritual symbolizing the transition from darkness to light—perfectly echoing our idea of “Spark the Mini Moment.”

Timeline

11.2

Winter time 冬令时当天

- First day of daylight saving time
- 20 Influencers per city are invited to attend the lighting moment

11.3~11.8

- MINISO lamplighters light the lamps daily at the city's light-up time
- Open to residents and tourists for spontaneous participation and check-ins





Toronto as an example

Week 2 (Day 1)

Lighting Ceremony
(This time may vary depending on the sunset time and the illumination schedule of the skyline on the day)



Signature wall



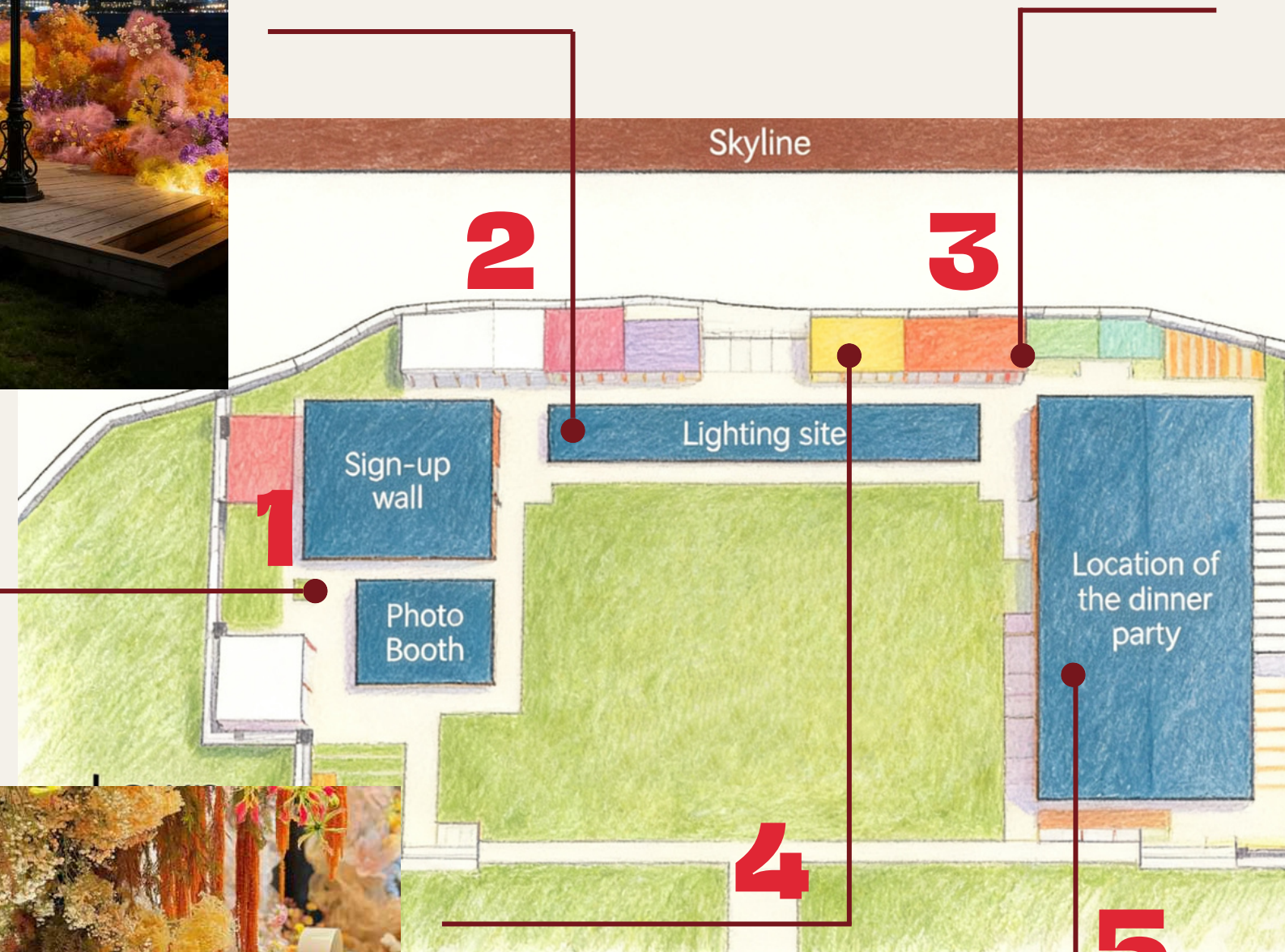
16:00

Mini bar



16:33

16:35~17:00

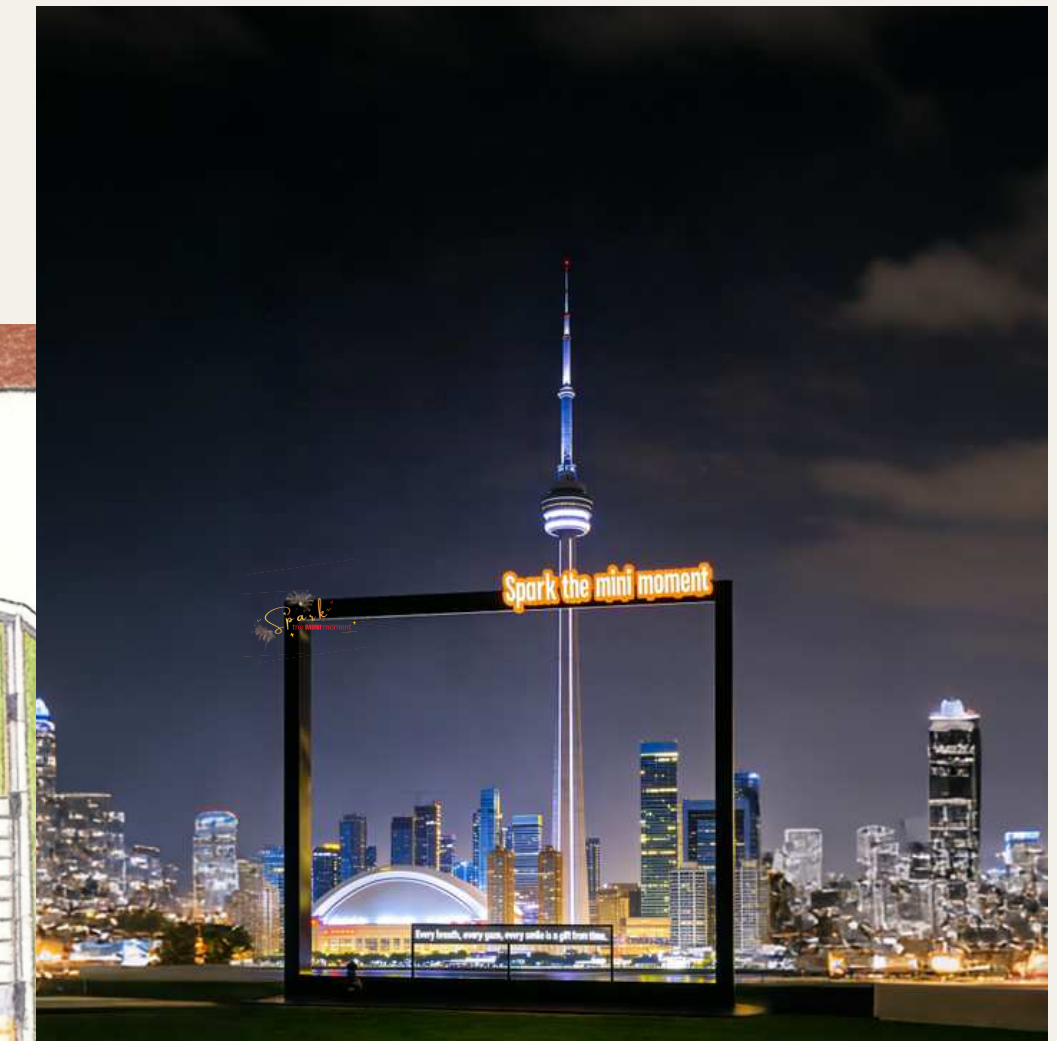


16:35~17:30

17:30~19:00

Dinner and gift boxes

Floor-standing film frame display device





Online - TVC



Spark Your Mini Moment



Protagonist: A girl who came to Vancouver to study at the age of 18.

Feeling **Sad** and **Homesick** due to the long winter time and academic pressure.

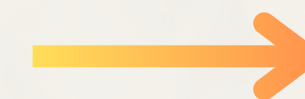
Style: The Warmth of Daily Life in Winter

Plot: On the first day of daylight saving time, the protagonist had a day at school in **Vancouver**.

- From the warmth of the morning, to the way to school, to the gloomy mood and cold atmosphere in the library.
- The final emotional shift on the way home from school during the first snowfall.
- The long winter nights, the beauty of actively discovering the sparks of life: snowflakes on the window, the glow of candles.
- A new day, discoveries and sparks of life.

Main shooting Perspective:

First-person perspective & Third-person perspective



**Immersive
Sense of presence.**

Week 1





Spark Your Mini Moment

	Frames	Main scenes	Copywriting
Morning		Scene - Dormitory in the early morning - On the table: The night light gradually lit up Action - She opened her eyes, but didn't get up immediately. - She reached out and turned off the light. The moment the light went out, the sunlight just streamed in.	“Some sparks are quiet”
Afternoon Snow		Scene - On the way home from school, at the bus stop - Snowflakes fall to the music. Action - She received a text message. Her mom sent a message saying “it’s snowing, Taking care” (The music gets louder.)	“Some sparks travel a long way”
New Day Morning		Scene - On a new morning, the window of the dormitory was covered with snowflakes, and the chirping of birds and the sunlight could be seen. - Empty shot of a snow scene (End) Action - She open the window	No matter when you start your day, Your Spark is on the way.



Online - social media promotion

Week 1

Preheating Promotion---Spark the dust



Toronto



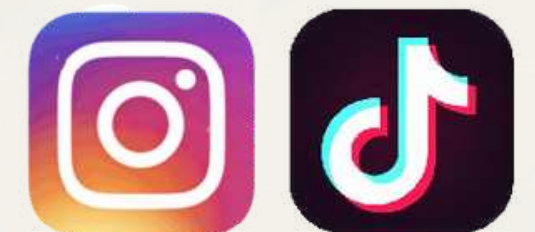
Vancouver



Montreal

INS copywriting :

miniso.canada When the city lights up, the moment sparks
Can you guess where we are?
This winter, cities across Canada are about to light up





Online - KOLs promotion

Week 2

Metro Sparks



6 creators (Photography creators, lifestyle creators)

Why these KOLs?



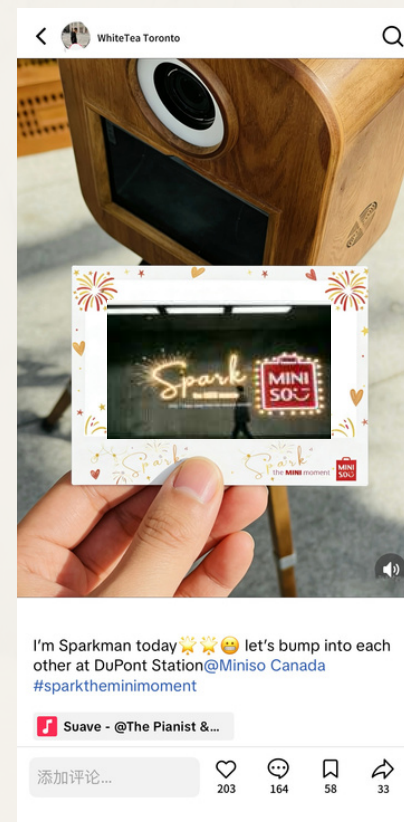
Has a large number of followers
Experience with “strangers photo” content

How to promote

- Post short videos and photos on social media about photo booth experiences
- Showcase real interactions with strangers

Tag MINISO and campaign hashtag

Primary channels: Instagram / TikTok



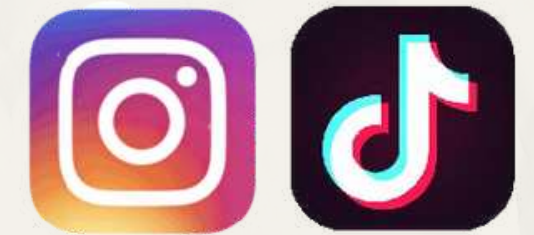
Value Exchange

Spark the Dusk



20 creators in each cities
(Overall 60 KOLs)
Models, lifestyle creators

Why these KOLs?



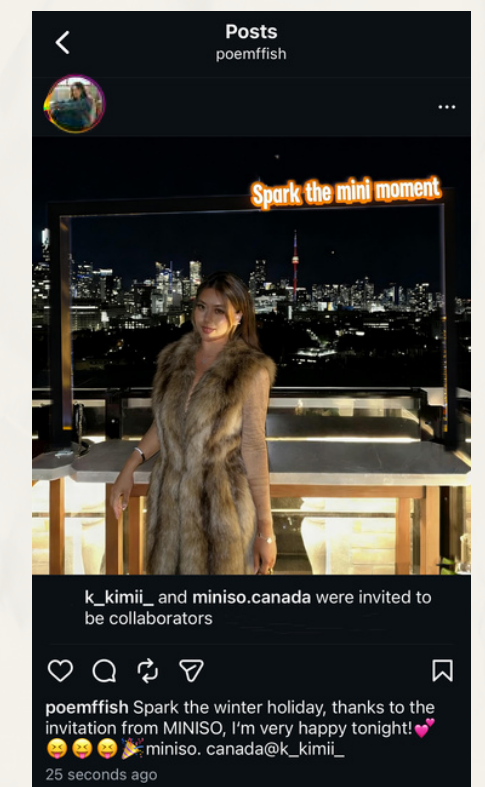
--Has a large number of followers
--Likes to post his/her own photos, and the fan base has a high overlap with our Target Audience.

How to promote

- Post short videos and photos on social media about our film frame display device.
- Show our gift on social media.

Tag MINISO and campaign hashtag

Primary channels: Instagram / TikTok





Online - #...Until I found my spark ✨



Why: Best hub for our target audiences, visual storytelling, and viral trends.



Hashtag:

#untilifoundmyspark ✨

#sparktheminimoment

Week3: Transition challenge
(Grey Winter → Spark Moment)

A “**before-and-after**” transition video syncs with trending audio.

Week4: Mystery Gift Drops
(Emotional Spark)

The mechanism of **random selection** creates **unpredictable surprise**.

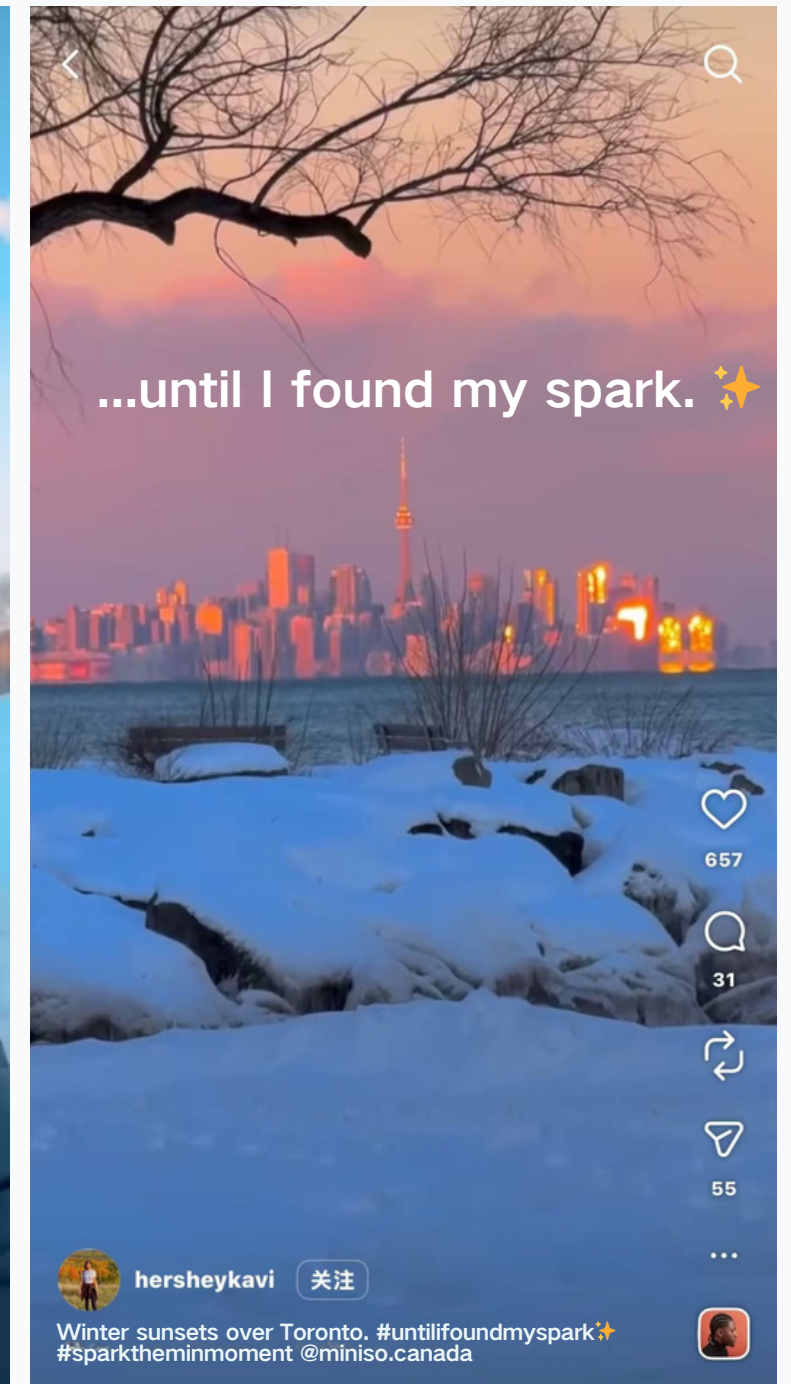
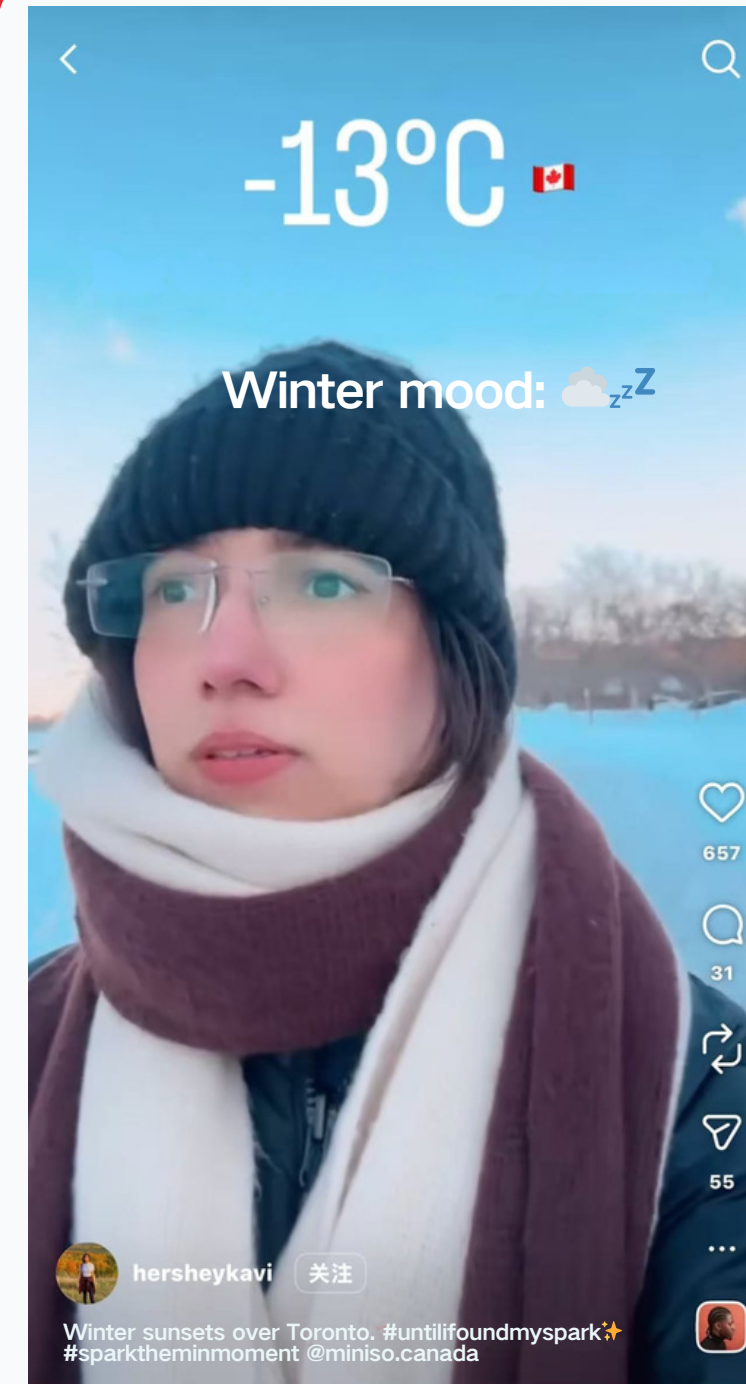
UGC fuel

Viral Spread

Ignite public participation by using simply made transition challenges and turn passive followers into active brand storytellers.

Community Engagement
(Collective Resonance)

Each individual spark micro-moment converges into a collective winter healing movement.



Week 3-4



Online - Video Recap



Week 4

The Endless Mini Spark

A campaign recap video aggregating event moments and UGC highlights.



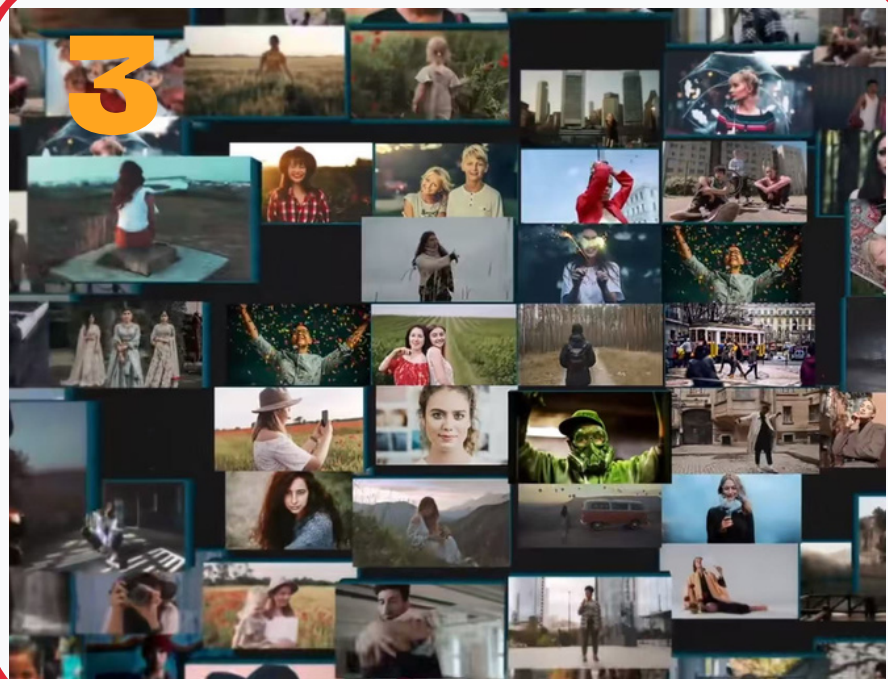
1



2



3



4



Copywriting Demo

Scene 1&2: Miniso Gives Spark

“We started this winter by lighting up the skyline and gave a little surprise...”

Scene 3: Exchange Spark

“We asked you what 'Spark' feels like. You answered with thousands of shining stories.”

Scene 4: Lights up Miniso

“Every mini moment you captured... is the light that builds MINISO. Thank you for being our endless spark.”

Key Message:

The campaign narrative evolves from Miniso sparking the user to the user sparking Miniso.

MINISO concludes by celebrating that our community's collective joy is the true source of our brand's light, promising an endless companionship through every mini moment.





SPARK THE MINI MOMENT Media Planning

Time	Tactics	Social Media	Action
Week 1 Oct. 26-Nov. 1	Poster & TVC	  	Stage 1 Teaser Phase 1. Online: Official account posts poster and TVC to promote. 2. Offline: The posters will launch in MINISO's offline stores and large shopping malls in three cities.
Week 2 Nov. 2-8	KOLs promotes online activities	 	Stage 2 Peak Phase 1. Online: KOLs promotes and users to actively generate and share related content. 2. Offline: Photos and out door display.
Week 3 Nov. 9-15	UGC Transition Challenge	 	Stage 2 Peak Phase 1. Online: Encourage users to post relevant content (UGC) to receive gifts. 2. Offline: Out door display
Week 4 Nov.16-22	UGC Lottery Interaction & Recap Video	  	Stage 3 Sustain Phase 1. Online Tiktok & Insgram: UGC Lottery Interaction Tiktok Insgram & Youtube: Recap Video



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